

Thomas Wedell-Wedellsborg

Reframing & the Art of Solving the Right Problem

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1 WHY THIS THINKER MATTERS

Most teams are brilliant at solving problems and terrible at choosing which problem to solve. Wedell-Wedellsborg's reframing method is the antidote — and the intellectual heart of Units 4 and 6. A better answer to the wrong question is still wrong.

2 INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

Danish author and advisor on innovation and problem-solving. His widely read HBR work and book *What's Your Problem?* turned reframing from a vague idea into a practical, teachable routine for individuals and teams.

"Don't just solve problems — make sure you're solving the right ones."

"Reframing is not about analysing a problem. It is about shifting the way you see it."

3 FRAMEWORKS · TOOLS · MODELS

NAME	WHAT IT IS
Reframing	Deliberately changing how a problem is understood
The elevator problem	Fix the wait, not just the elevator
Frame-reframe loop	Cycle between solving and questioning the frame
Outside-the-frame questions	What are we missing? Whose view is absent?
Right-problem test	Is this even the problem worth solving?

4 HOW IT'S OPERATIONALIZED

- Restate the problem several ways before ideating
- Ask who is not in the room and what frame they'd bring
- Look for the problem behind the presented problem
- Use the elevator heuristic to attack the experience, not the object
- Invest disproportionately in framing before solutions

5 LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUES

- Reframing can become endless if not time-boxed
- Practitioner framing, light on controlled evidence
- Risk of over-reframing simple, well-understood problems
- Depends on diverse perspectives being available
- Cultural and political barriers to challenging the frame

6 ENDURING IMPACT

- 'Are You Solving the Right Problems?' a top HBR article
- *What's Your Problem?* a standard reframing text
- Made reframing a mainstream managerial skill
- Widely used in innovation and consulting practice
- Direct anchor for BCOBM126 Units 4 and 6

SELECTED WORKS

WHAT'S YOUR PROBLEM? <i>To Solve Your Toughest Problems, Change the Problems You Solve</i> WEDELL-WEDELLSBORG · 2020	ARE YOU SOLVING THE RIGHT PROBLEMS? <i>Harvard Business Review</i> WEDELL-WEDELLSBORG · 2017	INNOVATION AS USUAL <i>with Paddy Miller</i> MILLER & W-W · 2013	THE REFRAMING CANVAS <i>HBR tools</i> WEDELL-WEDELLSBORG · 2020
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REFERENCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

- Wedell-Wedellsborg, T. (2017) 'Are You Solving the Right Problems?', *Harvard Business Review*, 95(1), pp. 76–83.
- Wedell-Wedellsborg, T. (2020) *What's Your Problem?* Boston: Harvard Business Review Press.